When God Draws a Line in the Sand

John P. Kennon
Manuscript excerpt

Reflections on Exodus and

God’s Unfailing Promises

By: John Paul Kennon

INTRODUCTION

Have you ever imagined that God draws lines in the sand? Recall the story of the woman caught in adultery—thrust before Jesus as He knelt to write in the dust. We don’t know His exact words, but we see the seismic impact: one act shattering oppressive rules, transforming her destiny, and leaving onlookers stunned. Even two thousand years later, that moment resonates with profound power. This was a line in the sand proverbially speaking, directly in front of their path. Daring the naysayers to cross, protecting the one forgiven.

Now consider a solitary line traced across the sand: steadfast and unmistakable, charged with meaning for all who pause to observe. If we journey further back, to the book of Exodus, we find God Himself carving lines that delivered hope to entire nations. Those lines changed the course of millions, echoing through generations, and remain today among one of the most celebrated victories in history. This was a line in the sand drawn as a path forward. A path of deliverance, hope and destiny. A way of escape from oppression, tyranny and slave masters. A way to advance forward in life and leave the past behind. Such is the beauty and power when God draws a line—clear, purposeful, eternal, and endlessly impactful.

Here's a description of various types of lines and their impacts:

1. Boundary Lines:

Effect: These lines create clear limits, providing safety and security. They protect what is within by defining what is without.

Affect: Establishing boundaries helps individuals and societies maintain order and prevent conflict. They teach us respect for others' spaces and rights.

2. Guiding Lines:

Effect: These lines act like maps, steering us in a specific direction with purpose and intent. They offer clarity in navigation and decision-making.

Affect: Guiding lines inspire confidence and motivation, giving us a sense of direction. They can help us achieve goals and fulfill our potential.

3. Dividing Lines:

Effect: These lines create divisions, highlighting differences and setting opposing sides apart.

Affect: They can lead to conflict, rivalry, or competition if not managed wisely. They may also foster uniqueness and identity within defined groups.

4. Threshold Lines:

Effect: Represent moments of transition or change, symbolizing moving from one state or place to another.

Affect: Crossing threshold lines can be empowering, marking the beginning of new chapters or opportunities. They are moments of courage and growth.

5. Connecting Lines:

Effect: These lines bridge gaps, linking people, places, or ideas into a coherent whole.

Affect: Connecting lines build unity and understanding, fostering relationships and collaboration. They bring together disparate elements into harmony.

6. Imaginary Lines:

Effect: While not physically present, these lines exist in minds or societies, shaping beliefs, strategies, or lifestyles.

Affect: Imaginary lines can drive innovation and creativity by encouraging thinking outside the box. They may also unlock potential through ideals and dreams.

Overall Impact:

Lines delineate our world, offering structure and meaning. While their effect provides a framework or blueprint, their effect deeply influences emotions, behaviors, and interactions. They teach us about balance—between freedom and restriction, individualism and community, change and stability. Recognizing and respecting these lines enriches our lives, guiding us in creating paths that reflect who we are within the shared landscape of humanity.

Biblical Example of Restrictive Lines:

The Ten Commandments etched in stone, guiding Israelites with divine boundaries.

Real-World Parallel:

Traffic lights glow red, stopping chaos and ensuring order on bustling city streets.

Biblical Example of Guiding Lines:

"Thy word is a lamp unto my feet," leading believers through life's uncertainties with hope.

Real-World Parallel:

Trail markers on a hiking path, steering adventurers safely through the woods.

Contrasting Statements:

Restrictive lines draw a boundary; guiding lines draw a map.

Boundaries hold us steady; pathways propel us forward.

Lines in the sand warn of danger; lines on the path promise direction.

Rules bind us for protection; principles lead us to purpose.